

Plan — Chase Pierson Photography

Owner: Chase Pierson Status: Active revenue source. Storefront launch pending Tracy review. Last updated: 2026-04-29

What it is

Chase Pierson Photography is Chase's commercial photography practice — corridor and Hudson Valley editorial, hospitality, music, and event work — operating as a DBA under Measurably Better Things LLC. It's the only line in the Records / Radio / Photography trio that produces real revenue today, and it doubles as the canonical image library for every Big Muddy property.

What's working today

A real list of things, not aspirational.

- Active client work: Inn shoots, Touring promo, Magazine editorial assignments.
- 600+ approved images in GCS (`bmt-media-bigmuddy`), tagged and routed.
- Print storefront in design — Tracy is currently reviewing 30 prints for launch.
- buycurious.art domain is live and routes to gallery.
- Every Big Muddy site uses Chase's photos under the `/approved/` photo policy.
- Existing revenue: ad-hoc commercial bookings, mostly via word of mouth in Natchez and Woodstock.

What's NOT yet running:

- Storefront isn't taking orders yet.
 - Day rate vs. project rate is undecided — pending Tracy's review.
 - No print fulfillment vendor selected (WHCC, Bay Photo, or in-house).
 - No formal client list / CRM.
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The economics

This is the actual revenue line. Records and Radio are 12–24 month plays. Photography pays now.

Current revenue baseline (estimate from last 6 months):

- Commercial shoots: 500–2,500 each, ~2–4/month = 1,000–10,000/month range
- Average month: ~\$3,000

Year 1 target with storefront live:

- Commercial: hold at 3,000–5,000/month
- Print storefront: 500–2,000/month after launch
- Total: 40,000–80,000/year, depending on storefront traction

Cost structure:

- Equipment: already owned (Sony bodies, Sigma + GMaster glass, lighting)
- Editing: in-house, Capture One + Photoshop
- Print fulfillment: 35–50% of retail to vendor (WHCC pricing model)
- Storefront tech: stripe + existing Next.js site = ~\$0 marginal
- Travel: passed through to client on commercial work

DBA relationship to MBT:

- All revenue flows to MBT bank account
- Chase draws as MBT founder distribution, not 1099
- Storefront margins fund Records + Radio shortfalls
- Image library is MBT-owned IP, not a personal asset

Photography is the cash engine that subsidizes the long-horizon plays.

The customer

Three customers, three different pricing models:

1. **Hospitality + commercial clients.** Inns, restaurants, venues, bands needing PR photography. Project rate, 500–5,000.
2. **Editorial + brand work.** Magazine spreads, brand campaigns, partner agencies (Tuthill, Studio C). Day rate or project, 1,500–2,500/day.
3. **Print storefront customers.** Direct-to-consumer art buyers. Tourists at the Inn, Magazine readers, Hudson Valley walk-ups. 40–300 per print.

Storefront is the volume play. Commercial is the margin play. Editorial is the brand play.

The 12-month plan

Q2 2026 (May–Jun) — Launch storefront

- Tracy completes 30-print review (in progress)
- Lock day rate vs. project rate decision (pending Tracy review)
- Select print fulfillment vendor: WHCC vs. Bay Photo
- Wire storefront checkout to Stripe under MBT entity
- Soft launch via Magazine + buycurious.art

Q3 2026 (Jul–Sep) — Drive volume

- Add 20 more prints to the storefront
- First in-Inn print display (lobby + suite walls — guests can scan QR to buy)
- First commercial print rate card published
- Bookings page on chasepierson.tv with calendar integration

Q4 2026 (Oct–Dec) — Expand corridor work

- Travel: Mississippi corridor + Hudson Valley shoots booked through Q4
- Pitch: Adams County tourism, Visit Natchez, Mississippi Tourism for licensed image library
- Holiday season: framed prints + gift cards on storefront

Q1 2027 (Jan–Mar) — Evaluate

- Did the storefront hit \$1,000/mo? If yes, expand.
 - Did commercial hold at \$3,000+/mo? If yes, raise rates.
 - Any licensed image library deals close? Repeat with the next region.
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What we need to make it happen

People

- Chase: shoot, edit, deliver

- Tracy: print curation review (in progress), rate card decision, contracts
- Patch: storefront checkout integration (~1 day of work)

Money

- Storefront launch cost: ~\$200 (sample prints from 2 vendors for quality test)
- Stripe + payments: existing
- No new gear required

Tools

- Print vendor account (TBD — Tracy + Chase decide)
- Stripe + Next.js checkout (Patch builds)
- Asana project for client pipeline
- Lightroom + Capture One catalog (already running)

Infrastructure

- Already have: gallery routing, image library, GCS bucket, domain
 - Need: storefront checkout, print rate card, day-rate decision
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The risk

1. **Tracy's review takes too long.** The storefront is bottlenecked on her print curation. Mitigate by giving her a deadline and a smaller batch (start with 10, not 30).
 2. **Day rate vs. project rate confusion.** If we don't decide, every quote is custom and slow. Decide once, stick to it.
 3. **Print fulfillment quality.** Bad prints kill brand trust faster than no prints. Order samples from 2 vendors before committing.
 4. **Chase's time is the bottleneck.** Every shoot is Chase-only. Doesn't scale past ~6 shoots/month unless we hire a second shooter (not in 2026 plan).
 5. **Photo policy enforcement.** Every image used on a Big Muddy property must be in `/approved/`. AI-generated images cannot ship. This is Chase's gate — a CMS slip-up that publishes an unapproved image hurts the whole ecosystem.
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Why it matters to the ecosystem

Photography is the visual identity of the entire Big Muddy ecosystem. It's the asset every other module depends on.

- **Inn uses it.** Every room, every menu, every site image.
- **Touring uses it.** Every band shot, tour poster, PR image.
- **Magazine uses it.** Every editorial spread, cover, social post.
- **Records uses it.** Album covers, artist press kits, music videos (eventually).
- **Radio uses it.** Show art, host headshots, brand visuals.
- **MBT uses it.** Sales decks, B2B pitches, partner case studies.
- **Bearsville uses it.** Hudson Valley shoots become Bearsville Creative's regional library.

Without Chase's photo library, every Big Muddy property looks generic. With it, the visual world is consistent across 14 domains and 5 brands. That's a competitive moat — competitors have to either license stock or hire a photographer; we have one in-house who knows the corridor and the people in it.

The DBA relationship to MBT also means image IP stays with the platform, not the individual. If Chase steps back from a brand, the photos don't leave with him. That's structurally important for long-term ecosystem value.

Decision needed

1. Tracy: 30-print review by **May 15**. Smaller batch acceptable (10 prints to launch, 20 to follow).
2. Chase + Tracy: lock day rate vs. project rate by **May 20**.
3. Patch: storefront checkout integration scheduled for **early June**.